SCHOOL OF DESIGN VOL. 01 — ISSUE 01 NOVEMBER 2026

THE DESIGN DESK

News, People and Processes from school of design

Setting the Baseline

01

Orientation 2026 welcomes the School of Design's newest cohort to campus with new faces, new questions and a first taste of belonging.



Orientation 2026 marked the beginning of a new chapter at the School of Design as a fresh batch of students stepped into campus for the first time. New faces, unfamiliar studios and plenty of questions filled the first few days as students were introduced to the people, spaces and culture that will shape the years ahead.

From faculty interactions and studio tours to ice-breaking sessions with classmates, the orientation was less about instructions and more about finding a sense of place. For the newest batch, it was the first glimpse into a school built around making, questioning, experimenting and learning through the process.

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What's Next? →



DHOLIDA 2026

Campus comes alive with Dholida 2026 — an evening of music, movement and celebration.

MORE → P.03

UPES × IIT GUWAHATI

UPES joins hands with IIT Guwahati (BioNEST), opening new possibilities

FULL STORY → P.02





SILVER FOR INDIA

A School of Design student brings home Silver for India at WorldSkills 2026.

MEET THE WINNER → P.02

Cross-Reference

Manchester meets UPES

The UPES School of Design welcomed faculty from Manchester Metropolitan University for an exchange of ideas and conversations around the evolving future of design education.

The interaction opened possibilities for deeper academic exchange and bringing different approaches to design, learning and creative practice to the same table.



Setting the Baseline- Orientation 2026

A New Chapter Begins

Orientation 2026 welcomed a new batch of students to the UPES School of Design, marking the beginning of their journey into a creative environment. The first few days introduced students to their peers, faculty, studios and the culture of learning through design.



Beyond schedules and introductions, orientation offered a first glimpse into a process built around questioning and experimenting. New conversations began to take shape as students from different backgrounds entered the same studios with their own ideas, interests and perspectives.

For the incoming batch, this is only the beginning—the first draft of the projects, mistakes, discoveries and experiences that will shape the years ahead. The baseline has been set; now the making begins.

Building Ideas for an AI-Driven Future

AITO-UPES and IIT Guwahati BioNEST have come together to present SPARC-AI, an 18-month programme aimed at empowering student innovators to develop AI-driven solutions for real-world challenges.

The programme focuses on areas including clean energy, sustainability and agritech, encouraging students to explore how artificial intelligence can create meaningful and practical impact.



UPES × IIT Guwahati:

Through field immersion, mentorship, grants and venture support, participants will have opportunities to develop their ideas beyond the classroom and transform challenges into potential solutions.

With a focus on purpose-led innovation, SPARC-AI creates a platform for students to experiment, build and work towards ideas with the potential for lasting impact.

02

Silver For India



At WorldSkills 2026

UPES School of Design alumnus Parth Vohra represented India at WorldSkills Shanghai 2026, bringing home a Silver medal in Industrial Design Technology.

The achievement came as India secured the 10th position at WorldSkills 2026, with six silver medals. Parth's performance placed design talent from UPES on an international stage.

Mentored by Anuj Prasad, CEO of Desmania, his journey highlights the role of skill, perseverance and mentor ship in transforming design practice into global achievement.

From the School of Design to the world stage, the win marks a proud moment for the UPES community and India's growing presence in design and innovation.

Celebrating the Class of 2025



UPES marked its 23rd Convocation, bringing together graduates, faculty and academic leaders to celebrate the achievements of the graduating class.

The ceremony recognised students' journeys while offering words of encouragement as they stepped into the next chapter of their professional lives.

OUT OF THE STUDIO

Dholida 2026







On 17 October, Dholida 2026 brought an evening of music, dance and festive energy to the UPES campus. Students stepped away from classrooms, studios and everyday routines to come together for a celebration filled with colour, traditional spirit and lively performances. The event created a shared space for students to participate, celebrate and experience campus life beyond academics.

As music and movement took over the evening, Dholida became more than just another event on the calendar. It offered students a chance to connect with one another, celebrate together and create memories outside their usual academic spaces. The vibrant atmosphere captured another side of student life at UPES—one where culture, community and celebration take centre stage.

Happiness Day 2026



Happiness Day doubled as a celebration for the new batch of students, welcoming freshers into campus life with an evening centred around music, energy and new beginnings. It gave the incoming students a chance to move beyond introductions and classrooms, meet their peers and celebrate the start of a new chapter together.

The evening came alive with a performance by singer Nikhita Gandhi, turning the freshers' celebration into a memorable concert experience. With students coming together for the performance, Happiness Day became both a welcome for the newest batch and a celebration of the community they are now a part of.



NEXT UP: SPANDAN 2026

26–29 NOVEMBER 2026

The campus is gearing up for Spandan 2026, bringing together four days of sports, music, dance, fashion and performance in a celebration of student life.

From the field to the stage, expect competition, creativity and plenty of campus energy as students come together to play, perform and participate.



OFF THE CLOCK

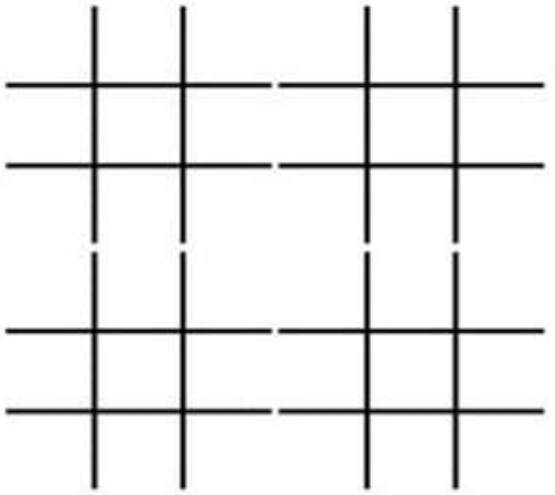
For when the deadline can wait.

DESIGNER SUDOKU

Take five. Your submission will survive.

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Tic-Tac-Toe



PLAY WITH A FRIEND

No screen required.

WORTH A WATCH

A curated selection of videos to spark ideas, sharpen your design thinking, and offer a fresh perspective beyond the studio.

04



01 / COLOUR THEORY



02 / DESIGN ETHICS



03 / DESIGN FUNDAMENTALS